

Severe allergy & anaphylaxis

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QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Trouble breathing, throat or tongue swelling, faintness or collapse after an allergen may be anaphylaxis. Use the person's prescribed epinephrine promptly according to its instructions and seek emergency care. Antihistamines do not replace epinephrine.

Do now.

**Act on serious symptoms**

01

Breathing trouble, swelling or collapse needs immediate care; a rash is not required. Get the prescribed epinephrine and request emergency assistance.

**Follow the actual device**

02

Assist with prescribed epinephrine according to the label, care plan or dispatcher. Different auto-injectors and nasal products have different instructions. Note the time.

**Keep them accompanied**

03

Use a comfortable position; lie down if showing shock when tolerated. Do not make the person stand or walk.

**Monitor and reassess**

04

If symptoms persist, follow the prescribed plan, product instructions or dispatcher for a repeat dose. If unresponsive and not breathing normally, begin CPR and use an AED.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Give prescribed epinephrine without waiting for a callback. Keep requesting urgent care and monitor breathing. Record the dose time and keep the used device for handover. Do not treat improvement as proof that the reaction has ended.

Watch for.

Do not substitute an antihistamine, food or drink for urgent treatment. Avoid a universal device hold-time: follow the product label.

People & practical needs.

Ask caregivers where the prescribed medicine is kept before an outing. Practice with the correct trainer device, explain who will fetch it and who will stay with the person, and check storage and expiry instructions

Next decision.

Urgent medical assessment is needed after epinephrine, including when symptoms improve. Replace used supplies and review the allergy action plan with a clinician.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

INCIDENT / SYMPTOM ONSET / LOCATION

HELP REQUESTED / RESPONSE CONFIRMED

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

American Red Cross – Allergic Reaction Anaphylaxis

AHA / Red Cross – 2024 first-aid guidelines

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/anaphylaxis/>